

Hyla chrysoscelis

Cope's gray treefrog



Length 1¼–2¼ in (3–6 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern

Location S. Canada, C. and E. USA



The blotchy gray coloring of this frog enables it to blend perfectly with a background of lichen-covered tree trunks. It can change color in different climatic or lighting conditions: turning darker in cold, dark conditions, and paler in bright light. Its blood contains glycerol, an "antifreeze" that enables it to survive subzero temperatures. Cope's gray treefrog is almost identical to another species, *H. versicolor*, which has a deeper-voiced call and twice the number of chromosomes.

Agalychnis callidryas

Red-eyed treefrog



Length 1½–2¼ in (4–7 cm)
Habit Terrestrial
Breeding Summer season
Status Least concern

Location Central America



The jewel-like coloration and red eyes make this one of the most striking frogs. In the breeding season, males congregate on branches overhanging a pond, and call out to females with a series of clicks. The male clambers onto the female's back to mate, and she descends to the pond, carrying the male with her, to take up water, then climbs back up into the tree to lay a batch of about 50 eggs on a leaf over the water. The process is usually repeated several times, the female drawing up water between each new batch of eggs. The eggs hatch after about 5 days, and the tadpoles fall into the pond.



prominent red eyes

GOOD CLIMBER

Like all tree frogs, the red-eyed treefrog has well-developed pads on all its toes to aid climbing.

COLORATION



This multihued frog has a green body, with blue and white stripes on its flanks; the insides of its legs are red and yellow. By day, it rests on leaves, with its legs folded along its sides in order to hide all the bright parts of its body, its green back providing camouflage.

Phyllomedusa hypochondrialis

Orange-legged leaf frog



Length 1–1¼ in (2.5–4.5 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season season
Status Least concern

Location N. to C. South America



An inhabitant of arid regions, this long, slender frog secretes a waxy substance from special glands, and rubs it all over its body to reduce water loss. Females surround their fertilized eggs with fluid-filled capsules in order to provide extra water for the developing eggs. The orange-legged leaf frog produces an unpleasant odor to ward off potential predators, and may also feign death.



green back

orange underside

Scinax ruber

Red-snouted treefrog



Length 1–1½ in (2.5–4 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season season
Status Least concern

Location S. Central America to N. South America, Caribbean



The red-snouted treefrog has a slender yellow, silver, or gray body. During the breeding season, males call very loudly to attract mates. The females, which are slightly larger than the males, select their mates on the basis of size, preferring those that are about 20 percent smaller than they are. This ratio allows closest contact with the male cloaca, so that the maximum number of eggs can be fertilized. The female scatters the eggs around the pond to reduce the impact of predation.



pointed snout

flattened body

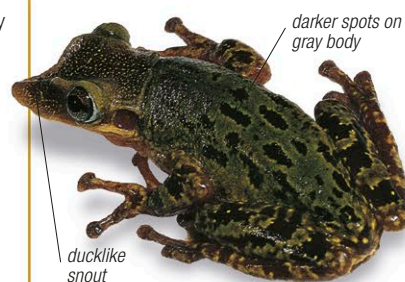
Tripion petasatus

Yucatan shovel-headed treefrog



Length 2¼–3 in (5.5–7.5 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season season
Status Least concern

Location Mexico (Yucatan region), N. Central America



darker spots on gray body

ducklike snout

Characterized by the unique shape of its head, the Yucatan shovel-headed treefrog has a flattened, ducklike snout, and saddlelike flaps behind the eyes, the function of which is unknown. It is gray, brown, or green, with darker spots, and has webbed toes and well-developed adhesive pads on its fingers and toes. This tree frog lives in shrubs and trees that occur in patches in grassland. Active only at night, by day it commonly hides in tree holes, which also provide a refuge during cold and dry weather.

Acris crepitans

Northern cricket frog



Length ½–1½ in (1.5–4 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern

Location E. and S. USA



This frog is able to leap large distances due to its long, powerful hind limbs. Its other characteristics include rough skin, and a distinctive, dark, triangular mark between the eyes. It is found among

foliage near swamps, ponds, streams, and lakes, and often basks in the sun. In early spring, large numbers converge in ponds, where the males call loudly to attract females, with a series of metallic clicks similar to the sound of crickets. In some areas, tadpoles have black tips on their tails to distract predators.

*Gastrotheca monticola*

Mountain marsupial frog



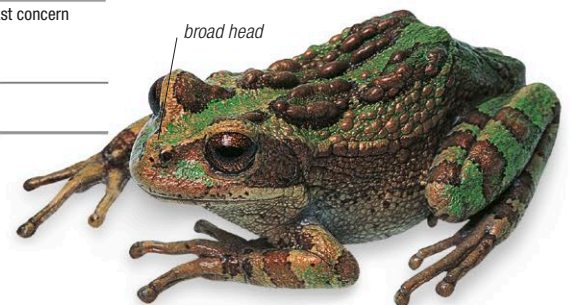
Length 1½–2¼ in (4–6 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Spring and summer
Status Least concern

Location N.W. South America



The female mountain marsupial frog has a brood pouch on her back. During mating, the male places the

eggs in the pouch, where they mature. The developing young are joined to the mother's blood system by a link similar to the placenta of mammals. After heavy rain, the mother releases young tadpoles into water (in some closely related species, the young are released as tiny adults). This frog is active at night, and hides under logs during winter and dry periods.



broad head